

Attendance & Working Hours Policy

Attendance records, missed punches, working hours, breaks, late arrival, and work-from-home attendance

Knowledge-base note: This document is fictional sample company policy content created for the WorkMate AI RAG demonstration. Employees should follow the actual company's approved procedures where they differ.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy explains how employees should record working time, report attendance problems, request corrections, and handle common situations involving punch-in, punch-out, breaks, and remote work.

Attendance records should accurately represent when an employee started work, took required breaks, and completed the working day. Employees are responsible for checking their records and reporting errors promptly.

2. Working Hours

Employees should follow the working schedule assigned to their team. The normal schedule, shift timing, or required availability may differ by department.

Employees should be available during required working hours unless they have approved leave, WFH, an adjusted schedule, or another authorized arrangement.

Managers may communicate team-specific schedules or meeting requirements. Employees should follow the schedule communicated for their role.

3. Punch-In Procedure

Employees must use the approved attendance portal or device to record the start of their workday.

After punching in, employees should confirm that the system accepted the attendance event. If the portal displays an error, the employee should report it instead of repeatedly submitting uncertain records.

Employees should not ask another person to record attendance on their behalf.

4. Punch-Out Procedure

Employees must record the required punch-out event at the end of the workday using the approved attendance system.

Before leaving, employees should verify that the punch-out was successful. A missing punch-out can create an incomplete attendance record and may require HR correction.

Employees should not intentionally leave attendance records incomplete.

5. What If I Forgot to Punch Out?

If an employee realizes that they forgot to punch out, they should report the missed punch to the designated HR or attendance contact as soon as they notice it.

The correction request should normally include the date, approximate departure time, employee ID, and a short explanation.

Example: An employee notices the next morning that yesterday's punch-out is missing. The employee should report the issue and provide the approximate time they left. HR can then review and correct the record according to the approved process.

Employees should not create a false punch time simply to complete the record. The correction must be based on the actual working time.

6. Missed Lunch Punch

If the attendance system requires lunch punch-out and punch-in events, employees must record both events correctly.

If an employee forgets a lunch punch, they should notify the attendance contact as soon as practical and provide the date, expected lunch period, and missing attendance event.

Example: An employee takes lunch from 1:30 PM to 2:30 PM but forgets the lunch punch-out. The employee should report the missing event and request the appropriate correction rather than changing the record without authorization.

Repeated missed lunch punches may be reviewed by the manager or HR.

7. Lunch and Breaks

Employees should follow the break duration and timing communicated for their team. Breaks should not be extended without appropriate approval.

If an employee is unsure whether a particular break requires an attendance event, they should ask HR or the attendance contact rather than guess.

Business-critical support teams may have different break arrangements because of coverage requirements.

8. Late Arrival

Employees who know they will arrive late should notify their manager as early as possible.

A late arrival should not be hidden by changing the attendance record. The actual attendance event should be recorded and the reason communicated through the approved process.

Repeated late arrival or unexplained attendance irregularities may result in a discussion with the manager and HR.

9. Early Departure

Employees who need to leave before the scheduled end of the workday should obtain the required approval and record attendance correctly.

Emergency situations should be communicated as soon as practical. The employee may be asked to complete an attendance correction or leave request afterward.

10. Attendance Correction

An attendance correction should contain enough information for the authorized reviewer to verify what happened.

Useful information includes the date, scheduled hours, actual time, missing event, reason, and any relevant system error.

Submitting a correction does not guarantee approval. The authorized reviewer determines whether the attendance record can be corrected.

11. Work From Home Attendance

WFH is allowed only when the employee is eligible and the required approval has been obtained.

Employees working from home are expected to follow their approved working hours and remain available for meetings and assigned work.

If the attendance system requires WFH punch-in and punch-out events, employees must record them using the approved method.

WFH does not automatically remove attendance requirements.

12. WFH Questions Employees Commonly Ask

Can I work from home tomorrow?

Only if the employee is eligible and the required approval has been obtained. A request should not be treated as approved merely because it was submitted.

Do I need to punch in while working from home?

If the attendance process requires WFH attendance events, yes. Employees should use the approved method.

I forgot my WFH punch-out. What should I do?

Report the missing event to the attendance contact and provide the date and approximate time, following the same correction procedure used for other missed punches.

My manager verbally approved WFH. Do I still need to submit a request?

Employees should follow the team's documented process and complete any required request or attendance record.

13. Attendance During System Problems

If the attendance portal is unavailable or an employee receives an error, the employee should record the issue and notify the designated support contact.

Employees should not repeatedly submit random times to make the system appear complete. The actual event should be documented for correction.

14. Repeated Attendance Issues

Repeated missed punches, repeated late arrivals, unexplained absences, or frequent manual corrections may be reviewed by HR and the manager.

The purpose of review is to understand the cause and determine the appropriate corrective process.

15. Common Employee Questions

Employees may ask WorkMate about missed punch-out procedures, lunch punch corrections, WFH attendance, late arrival reporting, early departure, and attendance correction requirements.

When the policy does not answer a specific situation, WorkMate should direct the employee to HR rather than invent a rule.